

Pattern, texture, and inclusions

Some gems grow in patterns that have a natural beauty, enhanced by a skilful cutter. The many varieties of quartz, including agates and chalcedonies such as jasper, are particularly renowned for their intrinsic decorative qualities. Other species of gem have unusual surface texture or inclusions within the stone that add beauty.



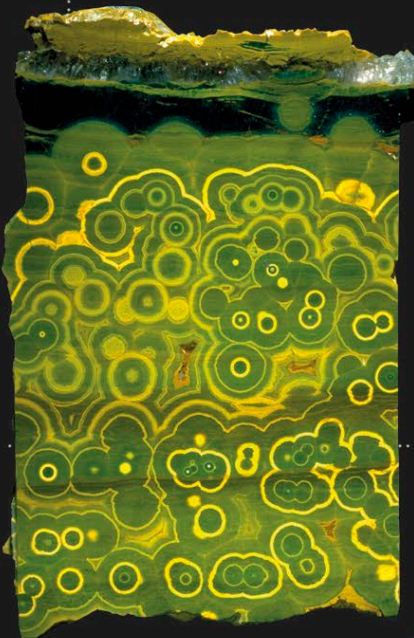
Apatite crystal

This large apatite crystal displays a number of small inclusions in its interior, giving it a fractured appearance.



Stained agate

This cabochon of agate has been stained to highlight the patterns created by its mineral inclusions.



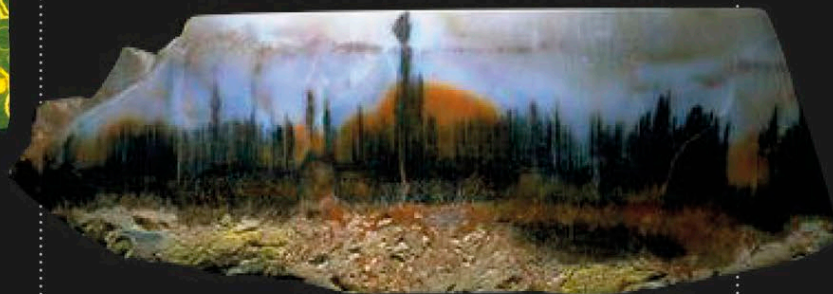
Orbicular agate

This stunning ring-shaped pattern features an "eye" in the centre of each small circle, seen here in a colourful cross-sectional polished slice of agate.



Baryte crystals

This cluster of tabular baryte crystals displays a jagged pattern and a waxy texture on its surfaces.



Landscape agate

In this distinctive naturally occurring pattern, images resembling a scene from nature are created by iron oxide dendrites.

